11.3 Inherited Traits and Learned Behaviors

4th Grade Science · Video: Inherited and Acquired Traits (Snap Standards)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

You Are One of a Kind

Everything about you is completely _____. No one is exactly like you.

All of your physical characteristics are called _____.

There are two types of traits: acquired traits and _____ traits.

Inherited Traits

Inherited traits are the ones you get from your biological _____.

When two people have a child, they each give 50 percent of their _____.

Their genes get _____ together, like a deck of cards.

That is why _____ look alike, but not exactly the same.

Acquired Traits

Acquired traits are things you get from your _____.

A _____ from falling off your bicycle is an acquired trait.

To be good at a board game, you have to _____ a lot.

Acquired traits can't be _____ to your kids.

Juggling a soccer ball is acquired, but your _____ is inherited.

In Texas science, skills you practice, like juggling or playing a board game, are called learned behaviors. A scar is acquired from the environment, but it is not a behavior.

DNA and Genes

Hair texture, eye color, and skin color are inherited traits. They are in your _____.

Your DNA is made up of genes.

Genes are kind of like the _____ in a cookbook. They tell your body what it will look like.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
trait	a characteristic, like eye color or hair texture
inherited trait	a trait you get from your biological parents
acquired trait	something you get from your environment, like a scar or a skill
learned behavior	something you learn to do by practice, like juggling a ball
gene	a tiny "recipe" in your DNA that helps decide how you look

Key Takeaways

• Inherited traits, like eye color, are passed from parents to children.

• Acquired traits and learned behaviors come from your environment and practice. They cannot be passed down.